

DAROUB

Mleiha

A compact field guide

Sharjah desert and heritage area around Mleiha Archaeological Centre, Fossil Rock and Jebel Faya; plan for heat and booking.

Reference edition dated 2026-09-18

A concise Daroub guide based on the listed sources. The location is approximate, not a trailhead. Check current weather and local closures before leaving.

25.132, 55.861 | Asia/Dubai

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01 Place and terrain

Visit Sharjah describes Mleiha in the Central Region as archaeology, nature and adventure around the centre, Fossil Rock and Jebel Faya. This is an approximate area marker for the centre and Fossil Rock, not a trailhead; the image is illustrative. Check site status on the day.

[Visit Sharjah](#) · [Mleiha City](#)

[Visit Sharjah](#) · [Mleiha National Park](#)

02 Equipment and preparation

Practical inference: because advertised activities include hiking, desert trips and camping, carry reserve water, offline navigation and a charged phone. Ask the operator what is supplied on a tour or camp, and do not assume walking or recovery equipment is included.

[Visit Sharjah](#) · [Mleiha National Park](#)

[National Center of Meteorology](#) · [Ghaith UAE Weather Maps](#)

03 Clothing and footwear

General advice, not a local requirement: use covering clothing, a hat, sunglasses and closed footwear suited to sand and gravel around Fossil Rock. Pack a light layer if your plan extends to stargazing or camp, and check the forecast on the day.

[Visit Sharjah](#) · [Mleiha National Park](#)

[National Center of Meteorology](#) · [Ghaith UAE Weather Maps](#)

04 Access and transport

Sources describe guided experiences and desert adventure in Mleiha. Practical inference: confirm the meeting point and return plan with the centre or operator before leaving, and do not treat the map marker as an off-road route. Sand and visibility can change; check on the day.

[Visit Sharjah](#) · [Mleiha City](#)

[Visit Sharjah](#) · [Mleiha National Park](#)

05 Season and conditions

The National Center of Meteorology provides UAE weather maps. Do not treat a general map as a local guarantee for Fossil Rock; pair it with the day forecast and reduce exposed walking in heat, dust or poor visibility. Rebook if conditions are unsuitable.

National Center of Meteorology · Ghaith UAE Weather Maps

06 Nature and identification limits

An ecological assessment at Mleiha records more than one hundred species in a protected desert landscape, including plants, mammals, reptiles, birds and invertebrates. This supports quiet observation planning, not guaranteed sightings. Do not collect plants, stones or fossils; stay with the guide.

Aletihad · Mleiha Park records 100+ species of flora, fauna in its habitat

07 Visit precautions

Limestone outcrops, dunes and exposed ground are present, and sources record vipers and scorpions in Mleiha. Practical inference: do not walk alone away from the tour, check footwear and use a light at night. In UAE emergencies call police 999, ambulance 998 or civil defence 997.

UAE Government portal · Handling emergencies (police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997)

Visit Sharjah · Mleiha National Park

Aletihad · Mleiha Park records 100+ species of flora, fauna in its habitat

08 Activity choice and booking

Visit Sharjah lists guided archaeological tours, Fossil Rock, trekking, desert trips, dune bashing, quad bikes and camp or glamping advice. Choose a shorter operated activity if experience is limited, and confirm booking, duration and weather-dependent terms before paying.

Visit Sharjah · Mleiha National Park

09 Rules and permits

Sources present Mleiha as a protected heritage and nature landscape, and advertised activities are generally through the centre or operators. Practical inference: do not enter archaeological or protected areas outside instructions, and do not fly a drone without registration and proper authorisation. Check camping or filming rules with the centre on the day.

[UAE Government portal](#) · [Handling emergencies](#) (police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997)

[Visit Sharjah](#) · [Mleiha City](#)

[Visit Sharjah](#) · [Mleiha National Park](#)

[General Civil Aviation Authority](#) · [UAS Registration](#)

Wildlife & plants

Ghaf tree

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

Mleiha biodiversity reporting lists ghaf among native plants that stabilise soil and create small desert microhabitats.

Do not break branches or collect firewood; observe shade and wildlife around the tree from a respectful distance.

[Aletihad](#) · [Mleiha Park records 100+ species of flora, fauna in its habitat](#)

Arabian red fox

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

Mleiha reporting identifies the Arabian red fox among desert-adapted mammals recorded in the park.

Do not feed foxes or leave food exposed at camp; a recorded presence does not guarantee sightings.

[Aletihad](#) · [Mleiha Park records 100+ species of flora, fauna in its habitat](#)

Sand gazelle

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

The Mleiha assessment records sand gazelle among desert mammals in the protected park landscape.

Observe quietly from a distance and never pursue by vehicle or on foot; stay with the route or guide instructions.

Aletihad · Mleiha Park records 100+ species of flora, fauna in its habitat

Arabian horned viper

Information linked to regional sources

Mleiha reporting lists the Arabian horned viper among desert reptiles; this is a hazard note, not a reason to search for it.

Keep hands out of cracks and under stones, use a light at night, and call medical help immediately after a bite.

Aletihad · Mleiha Park records 100+ species of flora, fauna in its habitat

Arabian fat-tailed scorpion

Information linked to regional sources

Mleiha reporting records this venomous scorpion among arachnids; it may shelter under rocks or near camps.

Check shoes and bags before use, avoid barefoot walking at night, and seek medical help after a sting.

Aletihad · Mleiha Park records 100+ species of flora, fauna in its habitat

Travel companions

A buddy-planning recommendation, not a safety guarantee. Remote or technical routes need group planning with a local expert. Avoid going alone.

Before you leave

Choose your route and turn-back point; check entry permissions and closures.

Check the forecast and save an offline map.

Review clothing, water, food and communication with your companions.

Agree a return time and alternative plan, and share them with a trusted contact.

Educational terrain examples, not a complete inventory or verified species list for these coordinates. Do not eat plants or animals based on this guide.

Sources and further reading

1. UAE Government portal · Handling emergencies (police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997)

<https://u.ae/en/information-and-services/justice-safety-and-the-law/Safety/handling-emergencies>

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2. Visit Sharjah · Mleiha City

<https://www.visitsharjah.com/en/regions/central-region/mleiha/>

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3. Visit Sharjah · Mleiha National Park

<https://www.visitsharjah.com/en/activities/adventure/mleiha-national-park/>

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4. Aletihad · Mleiha Park records 100+ species of flora, fauna in its habitat

<https://en.aletihad.ae/news/culture/4580377/mleiha-park-records-100--species-of-flora--fauna-in-its-habi>

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5. National Center of Meteorology · Ghaith UAE Weather Maps

<https://ghaith.ncm.gov.ae/?lang=en>

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6. General Civil Aviation Authority · UAS Registration

<https://www.gcaa.gov.ae/en/pages/UASRegistration.aspx>

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Further guide from the official publisher

Mleiha National Park - activities and heritage

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